

EUROPEAN COURT OF HUMAN RIGHTS
COUR EUROPÉENNE DES DROITS DE L'HOMME

THIRD SECTION

CASE OF KANYGIN AND OTHERS v. RUSSIA

(Applications nos. 49997/21 and 20 others –
see appended list)

JUDGMENT

STRASBOURG

21 March 2024

This judgment is final but it may be subject to editorial revision.



In the case of Kanygin and Others v. Russia,

The European Court of Human Rights (Third Section), sitting as a Committee composed of:

Peeter Roosma*, President*,
Ioannis Ktistakis,
Andreas Zünd*, judges*,

and Viktoriya Maradudina, *Acting Deputy Section Registrar,*

Having deliberated in private on 22 February 2024,

Delivers the following judgment, which was adopted on that date:

PROCEDURE

1. The case originated in applications against Russia lodged with the Court under Article 34 of the Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms ("the Convention") on the various dates indicated in the appended table.

2. The Russian Government ("the Government") were given notice of the applications.

THE FACTS

3. The list of applicants and the relevant details of the applications are set out in the appended table.

4. The applicants complained of the disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies. Some applicants also raised other complaints under the provisions of the Convention.

THE LAW

I. JOINDER OF THE APPLICATIONS

5. Having regard to the similar subject matter of the applications, the Court finds it appropriate to examine them jointly in a single judgment.

II. JURISDICTION

6. The Court observes that the facts giving rise to the alleged violations of the Convention occurred prior to 16 September 2022, the date on which the Russian Federation ceased to be a party to the Convention. The Court therefore decides that it has jurisdiction to examine the present applications (see *Fedotova and Others v. Russia* [GC], nos. 40792/10 and 2 others, §§ 68-73, 17 January 2023).

III. ALLEGED VIOLATION OF ARTICLE 11 OF THE CONVENTION

7. The applicants complained principally of disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies, namely their arrest in relation to the dispersal of these assemblies and their conviction for administrative offences. They relied, expressly or in substance, on Article 11 of the Convention.

8. The Court refers to the principles established in its case-law regarding freedom of assembly (see *Kudrevičius and Others v. Lithuania* [GC], no. 37553/05, ECHR 2015, with further references) and proportionality of interference with it (see *Oya Ataman v. Turkey*, no. 74552/01, ECHR 2006-XIV, and *Hyde Park and Others v. Moldova*, no. 33482/06, 31 March 2009).

9. In the leading cases of *Frumkin v. Russia,* no. 74568/12, ECHR 2016 (extracts), *Navalnyy and Yashin v. Russia,* no. 76204/11, 4 December 2014 and *Kasparov and Others v. Russia,* no. 21613/07, 3 October 2013, the Court already found a violation in respect of issues similar to those in the present case.

10. Having examined all the material submitted to it, the Court has not found any fact or argument capable of persuading it to reach a different conclusion as to the admissibility and merits of these complaints. Having regard to its case-law on the subject, the Court considers that in the instant case the interferences with the applicants' freedom of assembly were not "necessary in a democratic society".

11. These complaints are therefore admissible and disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention.

IV. OTHER ALLEGED VIOLATIONS UNDER WELL-ESTABLISHED CASE-LAW

12. Some applicants submitted other complaints which also raised issues under the Convention, given the relevant well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table). These complaints are not manifestly ill-founded within the meaning of Article 35 § 3 (a) of the Convention, nor are they inadmissible on any other ground. Accordingly, they must be declared admissible.

13. Having examined all the material before it, the Court concludes that these complaints also disclose violations of the Convention in the light of its findings in *Butkevich v. Russia*, no. 5865/07, §§ 63-65, 13 February 2018, *Tsvetkova and Others v. Russia*, nos. 54381/08 and 5 others, §§ 115-31, 10 April 2018, and *Korneyeva v. Russia*, no. 72051/17, §§ 34-36, 8 October 2019, as to various aspects of unlawful deprivation of liberty of organisers or participants of public assemblies; and *Karelin v. Russia*, no. 926/08, §§ 58-85,

20 September 2016, concerning the absence of a prosecuting party in the proceedings under the Code of Administrative Offences (the CAO).

V. REMAINING COMPLAINTS

14. Some applicants raised further additional complaints under Article 6 of the Convention concerning other aspects of fairness of the administrative-offence proceedings. In view of the findings in the above paragraphs, the Court considers that there is no need to deal separately with these remaining complaints.

VI. APPLICATION OF ARTICLE 41 OF THE CONVENTION

15. Regard being had to the documents in its possession and to its case-law (see in particular *Navalnyy and Others v. Russia* [Committee], nos. 25809/17 and 14 others, § 22, 4 October 2022), the Court finds it reasonable to award the sums indicated in the appended table.

FOR THESE REASONS, THE COURT, UNANIMOUSLY,

1. *Decides* to join the applications;

2. *Holds* that it has jurisdiction to deal with these applications as they relate to facts that took place before 16 September 2022;

3. *Declares* the complaints under Article 11 of the Convention and the other complaints under the well-established case-law of the Court, as set out in the appended table, admissible, and *finds* that there is no need to examine separately the remaining complaints under Article 6 of the Convention;

4. *Holds* that these applications disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention;

5. *Holds* that there has been a violation of the Convention as regards the other complaints raised under the well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table);

6. *Holds*
   (a) that the respondent State is to pay the applicants, within three months, the amounts indicated in the appended table, to be converted into the currency of the respondent State at the rate applicable at the date of settlement;
   (b) that from the expiry of the above-mentioned three months until settlement simple interest shall be payable on the above amounts at a

rate equal to the marginal lending rate of the European Central Bank during the default period plus three percentage points.

Done in English, and notified in writing on 21 March 2024, pursuant to Rule 77 §§ 2 and 3 of the Rules of Court.

Viktoriya Maradudina Acting Deputy Registrar	Peeter Roosma President

APPENDIX

List of applications raising complaints under Article 11 of the Convention
(disproportionate measures against organisers and participants of public assemblies)

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
1.	49997/21 27/09/2021	**Yuriy Alekseyevich KANYGIN** 1989	Martynova Tatyana Georgiyevna Pskov	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Pskov 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 12,000	Pskov Regional Court 29/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
2.	51121/21 01/10/2021	**Yekaterina Aleksandrovna SHISHKOVA** 2002	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 02/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceeding; Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report	4,000
3.	51123/21 01/10/2021	**Kirill Filippovich BLEKVARD** 1990	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 16,000	Moscow City Court 02/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
4.	51125/21 01/10/2021	**Artur Petrovich ZHDANOV** 1987	Sirosh Fedor Yevgenyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 02/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings; Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report	4,000
5.	52346/21 01/10/2021	**Anna Sergeyevna POPKOVA** 2000	Nurgaleyev Danil Ilnurovich Kazan	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 07/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
6.	52349/21 01/10/2021	**Alevtina Feliksovna SYNTINA** 1999	Nurgaleyev Danil Ilnurovich Kazan	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 05/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
7.	53270/21 06/10/2021	**Nikita Igorevich FIRSOV** 1990	Zinovyev Konstantin Mikhaylovich Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Dzerzhinsk 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 2 of CAO	fine of RUB 25,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 07/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings; Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 12.30 p.m. until 7.45 p.m. on 31/01/2021	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
8.	53288/21 07/10/2021	**Nikita Alekseyevich MITROFANOV** 1995	Usanova Olimpiada Valentinovna Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 07/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings; Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 12.40 p.m. on 31/01/2021 until 1.30 p.m. on 01/02/2021	4,000
9.	54360/21 20/10/2021	**Dmitriy Sergeyevich TELESHENKO** 1993	Dimitriyev Dmitriy Sergeyevich Orenburg	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Orenburg 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Orenburg Regional Court 20/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
10.	55444/21 08/11/2021	**Stepan Viktorovich BOCHKAREV** 1977	Eysmont Mariya Olegovna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 17/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	5,000
11.	55450/21 08/11/2021	**Polina Alekseyevna KURILO** 1995	Eysmont Mariya Olegovna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 19/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
12.	55842/21 27/10/2021	**Ioanna Vladimirovna MAYATSKAYA** 2002	Polyakov Daniil Alekseyevich Voronezh	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Voronezh 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Voronezh Regional Court 28/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings , Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report	4,000
13.	55861/21 28/10/2021	**Pavel Vasilyevich STEPANOV** 1983	Kosnyrev Vladislav Vladimirovich Syktyvkar	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Syktyvkar 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Komi Supreme Court 28/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
14.	55956/21 27/10/2021	**Asya Fedorovna SHULBAYEVA** 1957	Pryanishnikov Aleksey Aleksandrovich Tomsk	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Tomsk 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Tomsk Regional Court 02/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 21/04/2021 for compiling an offence report Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
15.	55978/21 04/11/2021	**Aleksey Olegovich YELDASHEV** 1996	Mikhaylova Varvara Dmitriyevna St Petersburg	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Kazan 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Tatarstan Republic 05/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
16.	56413/21 23/10/2021	**Mikhail Andreyevich VORONCHIKHIN** 1989	Popkov Aleksandr Vasilyevich Sochi	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Sochi 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Krasnodar Regional Court 26/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings; Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report	4,000
17.	56651/21 23/10/2021	**Sergey Vyacheslavovich MITROFANOV** 1995	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Voronezh 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 12,000	Voronezh Regional Court 28/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 2.20 p.m. until 7.50 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
18.	56922/21 29/10/2021	**Nikolay Vladimirovich MESHCHANOV** 1989	Vasilyev Aleksey Alekseyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 28/04/2021 (the full text of the decision received several days later)	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report; Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
19.	56926/21 28/10/2021	**Kristina Vyacheslavovna NUDNER** 1996	Vasilyev Aleksey Alekseyevich Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 28/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings; Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
20.	57395/21 08/11/2021	**Roman Igorevich KLIMOV** 1986	Kapishnikov Vladimir Sergeyevich Orel	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Orel 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Orel Regional Court 30/07/2021		3,500
21.	57399/21 14/11/2021	**Khurshed Akhmedovich AMINOV** 1988	Eysmont Mariya Olegovna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 19/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings; Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report	4,000

[1] Plus any tax that may be chargeable to the applicants.